MICHAEL (MIKE) SPICK

Technology Operations Leader | IT Service Management (ITSM) | Change, Release and Configuration Management
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SUMMARY

Technology operations leader with 12 years at PokerStars, Flutter International, and Flutter UKI, progressing from Production Support Analyst to Head of Configuration, Change, and Release. Built service desk, incident, problem, change and Configuration Management Database (CMDB) practices at PokerStars, then rolled them out across Flutter International brands: hundreds of teams, 5+ global locations and regulated markets. Leads global teams on governance and controls, risk-based change, audit and compliance (SOX, ISO 27001) and service level objective (SLO) reporting, and has brought AI into UK and Ireland (UKI) change management. ITIL 4 certified; Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

CORE SKILLS

- **Service management:** ITIL 4 practices; incident, problem, change, release and configuration management; major incident management and incident command; service desk leadership; post-incident reviews (PIRs)
- **Configuration and CMDB:** CMDB strategy and product ownership; CMDB consolidation; shift-left configuration data governance; asset management; cloud migration (service and operations); AWS asset management
- **Governance, risk and resilience:** Risk-based change; governance controls; Sarbanes-Oxley (SOX), ISO 27001 and internal assurance audits; operational resilience; crisis management; disaster recovery and business continuity
- **Performance reporting:** Key performance indicators (KPIs) and SLOs; availability, mean time to identify (MTTI) and mean time to resolve (MTTR) baselining; outage impact analysis
- **Leadership and planning:** Global team leadership; workforce planning; site leadership; executive communication
- **Transformation and automation:** AI-enabled change management; automated change framework; Lean continuous improvement; multi-brand service transformation
- **Tools:** Jira, Jira Service Management, Jira Assets, GitHub, Jenkins, PagerDuty; monitoring and observability tooling

EXPERIENCE

Flutter International (including PokerStars) | Toronto, ON, Canada | Oct 2014 - Present

Head of Configuration, Change, and Release | Sep 2022 - Present

Internal role: Tribe Lead, Technical Services, supporting PokerStars, Paddy Power, Betfair and Sky Betting & Gaming.

- Lead change, release and configuration management for Flutter International, managing people across Canada, the UK and Ireland, and Bulgaria and governing thousands of changes per month; own the related policies and strategy.
- Accountable for measuring and reporting on monthly change-related targets; own the change, configuration and release processes behind 99.9% availability
- Rolled out change management for Flutter International on a scalable, automated, risk-based change framework built with cross-functional stakeholders.
- Leading a program to converge the separate International and UKI change processes into one shared process, alongside the configuration data management work below.
- Represent change, release, configuration and asset management in SOX, ISO 27001 and internal assurance audits, with multiple clean annual audits and positive auditor feedback on the modern approach to change governance and automation.
- Brought AI into change management: AI for weekly and monthly change reporting and for auditing change-record quality to flag non-compliant changes; AI feedback on human risk assessments using historical change, incident and configuration data.
- Leading CMDB consolidation of 5+ configuration databases toward one source of truth; reviewing a shift-left governance model that applies standards at the data source, with an aggregation platform serving configuration data at query time to the CMDB or AI platforms.
- Built a unified team of change, release and configuration managers focused on risk-aware service protection, and a release culture centred on feedback, waste reduction and automation.
- Define, measure and report SLOs; manage resources, CAPEX reporting and workforce planning to match business priorities.
- Led teams that wrote disaster recovery and business continuity runbooks and supported test exercises across tens of teams; directly lead the release management team and support operational teams.
- Supported PokerStars' on-prem to cloud migration from a service and operations perspective: enabled technical change management, organized an AWS-led learning event that Flutter International adopted globally, and helped set

AWS asset management standards in UKI; PokerStars' public AWS case study cites a 40% increase in production change rate.
- Contribute to Toronto site leadership, including organization change and people strategies, supporting local diversity, inclusion and wellbeing initiatives.

Senior Manager, Technical Service Operations | Mar 2021 - Sep 2022
- Rolled out incident, problem and CMDB practices from PokerStars to Flutter's International division (PokerStars, FoxBet, Flutter Studios, Singular) across hundreds of teams, 5+ global locations and regulated markets, including business-to-business (B2B) brands that integrate with external and internal partners; landed the CMDB in 2022.
- Managed brand migrations to other service teams and expanded service desk and incident management teams internationally, enabling 24/7 on-site coverage.
- Led the Crisis Management group for service and operations, directing service and operations teams through crises and giving executive leadership and the wider crisis team clear, directive updates.
- Served as CMDB product owner, leading its vision and design for service management, security and compliance.
- Defined KPIs and delivered service performance reporting, real-time operational insights and outage impact assessments covering revenue loss and customer satisfaction.
- Built a production operations knowledge base of runbooks and playbooks; joined the Canadian office leadership team representing service and infrastructure.

Manager, Technical Service Operations (PokerStars) | Jan 2019 - Mar 2021
- Built and led a service desk and incident management organization of about 30 managers, team leads and analysts, handling 15+ major incidents per week, 24/7.
- Baselined availability, MTTI and MTTR, driving continual improvement that raised availability; reduced MTTI with PagerDuty plus monitoring and observability improvements, and reduced MTTR by introducing incident commanding.
- Established risk-based problem management and post-incident reviews, giving insight into repeat incidents and driving continual improvement; owned the major incident process and its compliance reviews.

Team Lead, Production Support (PokerStars) | Jan 2016 - Dec 2018
- Led a team of 5 supporting all PokerStars production services.
- Improved ticketing systems for better reporting and insight, and worked with quality assurance (QA) teams to identify known issues and cut production triage time.

Production Support Analyst (PokerStars) | Oct 2014 - Dec 2015 | Richmond Hill, ON
- Owned resolution of production issues from the backlog; triaged reports and analysed causes using backend tools and reports, client- and server-side logs and databases.
- Wrote scripts to automate repeatable tasks and supported development and QA teams with root cause analysis.

Genpak | Aurora, ON, Canada

System Administrator | Nov 2012 - Oct 2014
- Supported hundreds of users across 3 locations: enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems, Active Directory, intranet and knowledge bases, office and factory networks, Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) servers and Lotus Notes email servers.
- Delivered ERP and mobile device management (MDM) system replacements and revamped the intranet knowledge bases.

EDUCATION

Advanced Diploma, Computer Engineering Technology | Humber College | 2008 - 2012
ILM Level 7 Strategic Leadership and Management Programme | Leeds Beckett University | 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

- ITIL 4 Specialist: Create, Deliver and Support
- ITIL 4 Foundation
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Jira ITSM and SDLC Lab (project ODB, oddbrew.atlassian.net)
- Built a hands-on Jira portfolio lab modelling AI-enabled ITSM and software development lifecycle (SDLC) workflows through Cursor, GitHub, and Jira.